

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 22

The Murakkab Isharee

1. Opening — a Qur'anic verse

إِنَّ هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ يَهْدِي لِلَّتِي هِيَ أَقْوَمُ وَيُبَشِّرُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ الَّذِينَ يَعْمَلُونَ الصَّالِحَاتِ أَنَّ لَهُمْ أَجْرًا كَبِيرًا

(Surah Bani Isra'il: 9)

Translation: Indeed this Qur'an guides to that which is most upright, and gives glad tidings to the believers who do righteous deeds that for them is a great reward.

At the very beginning of this verse comes **هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ**, and this is the subject of the present lesson. It is a *Murakkab Isharee*.

2. Mufrad and Murakkab

Any word — whether an *Ism*, a *Fi'l* or a *Harf* — when used alone, apart from a sentence, is called a *Mufrad* in the terminology of Arabic grammar. And when a *mufrad* joins another *mufrad*, a *Murakkab* is formed. The *Murakkab* is of two kinds: the *Murakkab Naqis* and the *Murakkab Tamm*.

Kind	Definition	Examples
Murakkab Tamm	A Murakkab from which the sense is complete, that is, a full sentence	رَبِّدُّ صَالِحٌ
Murakkab Naqis	A combination of two or more words from which the sense is not completed	a good boy , the boy's book , this book , in the book

3. The definition of the Murakkab Isharee

Definition: A *Murakkab Naqis* in which the *Asma' ul Isharah* are used is called a *Murakkab Isharee*. As in **هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ ، هَذَا الْكِتَابُ ، هَذَا الْكُرْسِيُّ**.

Worth remembering: Since a *Murakkab Isharee* is a *Murakkab Naqis*, it does not by itself form a sentence. Saying "this Qur'an" does not complete the sense — the listener is left waiting to hear what is being said about it. This construction forms **one element** of a sentence, not a whole sentence.

The two parts of a Murakkab Isharee

- *Ism ul Isharah* — the word by which the pointing is done.
- *Mushar Ilayh* — that which is pointed at is called the *Mushar Ilayh*.

The rule of order: In Arabic the *Ism ul Isharah* is written first and the *Mushar Ilayh* after it. And in forming a *Murakkab Isharee*, the *Mushar Ilayh* is kept in view — that is, the *Ism ul Isharah* is chosen to match it.

هَذَا الطَّالِبُ

Ism ul Isharah + Mushar Ilayh
(this student)

4. The complete table of the Asma' ul Isharah

The *Asma' ul Isharah* are of two broad kinds. Those for **what is near** are used for a thing close at hand, and those for **what is far** for a thing at a distance. A separate *Ism ul Isharah* is used for the masculine, the feminine, the singular, the dual and the plural.

Kind	Wahid	Tathniyah — raf'	Tathniyah — nasb & jarr	Jam'
Mudhakkar, near	هَذَا	هَذَانِ	هَذَيْنِ	هَؤُلَاءِ
Mu'annath, near	هَذِهِ	هَاتَانِ	هَاتَيْنِ	هَؤُلَاءِ
Mudhakkar, far	ذَلِكَ	ذَلِكَ	ذَيْنِكَ	أُولَئِكَ
Mu'annath, far	تِلْكَ	تَانِكَ	تَيْنِكَ	أُولَئِكَ

- The singular and plural *Asma' ul Isharah* are *Mabni*, that is, their outward form stays one and the same in all three states of *raf'*, *nasb* and *jarr*.
- Only the dual *Asma' ul Isharah* are *Mu'rab*, that is, their form in the state of *raf'* differs from that in *nasb* and *jarr*.
- For the plural there is one word for both genders: هَؤُلَاءِ for the near and أُولَئِكَ for the far.

5. Agreement between the *Ism ul Isharah* and the *Mushar Ilayh*

The choice of the *Ism ul Isharah* follows the *Mushar Ilayh*. In a *Murakkab Isharee* too, agreement in gender, number and *I'raab* is required.

Aspect	Rule
Jins	If the <i>Mushar Ilayh</i> is masculine the <i>Ism ul Isharah</i> is masculine, and if feminine then feminine
'Adad	If the <i>Mushar Ilayh</i> is <i>Wahid</i> , <i>Tathniyah</i> or <i>Jam'</i> , the <i>Ism ul Isharah</i> will be of that same number
I'raab	Whatever state of <i>I'raab</i> the <i>Mushar Ilayh</i> is in, the <i>Ism ul Isharah</i> is reckoned to be in that state too

The particular case of *Wus'at*

The most important rule: In respect of *wus'at* the *Asma' ul Isharah* are *Ma'rifah*, so the *Mushar Ilayh* too is brought as *Ma'rifah*. Accordingly, in a *Murakkab Isharee* the *Mushar Ilayh* is always *Mu'arraf bil Lam* — that is, it will certainly carry *alif lam*.

This is why one says هَذَا الْكِتَابُ and not هَذَا كِتَابٌ — because the second form is not a *Murakkab Isharee* at all but a *Jumla Ismiyyah*.

6. The *I'raab* of a *Murakkab Isharee*

Since the singular and plural *Asma' ul Isharah* are *Mabni*, their *I'raab* cannot be known from their own form. In such a case the *I'raab* of the whole *Murakkab Isharee* is determined by looking at the *I'raab* of the *Mushar Ilayh*.

Rule: If the *Mushar Ilayh* is *Marfoo'*, the *Ism ul Isharah* is reckoned *Marfoo'* too; if *Mansoob*, then *Mansoob*; and if *Majroor*, then *Majroor*.

Murakkab Isharee	I'raab of the <i>Mushar Ilayh</i>	How the <i>Ism ul Isharah</i> is reckoned
هَذَا الْوَلَدُ	Marfoo'	mahallan Marfoo'
هَذَا الْوَلَدَ	Mansoob	mahallan Mansoob
هَذَا الْوَلَدِ	Majroor	mahallan Majroor

I'raab Mahalli: Since the *I'raab* of a *Mabni* noun is not visible, it is stated *mahallan*, that is, by position. The word هَذَا will be written the same in all three states; only its position changes.

The case of the dual

Since the dual *Asma' ul Isharah* are *Mu'rab*, the *I'raab* is plainly visible in them and the form itself changes.

- State of *raf'*: هَذَانِ الْوَلَدَانِ — these two boys. Here the *Mushar Ilayh* الْوَلَدَانِ is *Marfoo'*, so the *Ism ul Isharah* came as هَذَانِ.
- States of *nasb* and *jarr*: هَذَيْنِ الْوَلَدَيْنِ — here the *Mushar Ilayh* الْوَلَدَيْنِ is *Mansoob* or *Majroor*, so the *Ism ul Isharah* changed to هَذَيْنِ.

7. The method of translation

Rule: In translating, the *Ism ul Isharah* is rendered first and the *Mushar Ilayh* after it.

So in هَذَا الْقُرْآنُ, هَذَا means "this" and الْقُرْآنُ means "Qur'an", giving the whole as "this Qur'an".

Translating the al-: The *Mushar Ilayh* certainly carries *alif lam*, but it is not rendered separately as "that" in translation. هَذَا الْكِتَابُ is "this book", not "this that book" — because the sense of pointing itself supplies the definiteness.

8. Joining Hadhihi to a word with al-

When the word هَذِهِ stands alone, the kasrah beneath its final haa' is written standing and is drawn out in reading. But when it is joined to a word carrying *alif lam*, that kasrah becomes light and runs into the letter that follows.

هَذِهِ ← هَذِهِ الْبِنْتُ

(this girl)

9. Complete drills on the Murakkab Isharee

First drill

Kind	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
near Mudhakkar	هَذَا الْوَلَدُ	هَذَانِ الْوَلَدَانِ	هَؤُلَاءِ الْأَوْلَادُ

Kind	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
near Mu'annath	هَذِهِ الْبِنْتُ	هَاتَانِ الْبِنَتَانِ	هُؤُلَاءِ الْبَنَاتُ
far Mudhakkar	ذَلِكَ الصَّادِقُ	ذَلِكَ الصَّادِقَانِ	أُولَئِكَ الصَّادِقُونَ
far Mu'annath	تِلْكَ الصَّادِقَةُ	تَانِكَ الصَّادِقَتَانِ	أُولَئِكَ الصَّادِقَاتُ

Second drill

Kind	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
near Mudhakkar	هَذَا الطَّالِبُ	هَذَانِ الطَّالِبَانِ	هُؤُلَاءِ الطَّالِبُونَ
near Mu'annath	هَذِهِ الطَّالِبَةُ	هَاتَانِ الطَّالِبَتَانِ	هُؤُلَاءِ الطَّالِبَاتُ
far Mudhakkar	ذَلِكَ الصَّالِحُ	ذَلِكَ الصَّالِحَانِ	أُولَئِكَ الصَّالِحُونَ
far Mu'annath	تِلْكَ الصَّالِحَةُ	تَانِكَ الصَّالِحَتَانِ	أُولَئِكَ الصَّالِحَاتُ

10. The particular rule for a Ghayr 'Aqil plural

Rule: If the *Mushar Ilayh* is a *Jam' Mukassar* of the *Ghayr 'Aqil*, then by the rule of Arabic the **singular feminine Ism ul Isharah** is used for it — that is, هَذِهِ or تِلْكَ. The plural *Ism ul Isharah* هُؤُلَاءِ will not be used.

Singular	Ghayr 'Aqil plural	Translation
هَذَا الْقَلَمُ	هَذِهِ الْأَقْلَامُ	this pen · these pens
هَذَا الْكِتَابُ	هَذِهِ الْكُتُبُ	this book · these books
هَذَا السَّرِيرُ	هَذِهِ السَّرُرُ	this couch · these couches

The word قَلَمٌ is masculine, yet for its plural الْأَقْلَامُ the *Ism ul Isharah* هَذِهِ has come — because for a plural of the *Ghayr 'Aqil* the singular feminine alone is used.

11. A table of practical examples

Arabic construction	Translation	Explanation
هَذَا الرَّجُلُ	this man	singular masculine
هَذَانِ الْمُعَلِّمَانِ	these two teachers	dual masculine, state of raf'
هَذِهِ الْكُتُبُ	these books	هَذِهِ came because it is a Ghayr 'Aqil plural
هَاتَانِ الْمُعَلِّمَتَانِ	these two lady teachers	dual feminine, state of raf'
أُولَئِكَ النِّسَاءُ	those women	plural feminine, far, 'Aqil
تِلْكَ النَّافِذَةُ	that window	singular feminine, far
ذَلِكَ الْوَلَدُ الصَّالِحُ	that righteous boy	a Sifah used with a Murakkab Isharee
هَذَا الْبَلَدُ الْأَمِينُ	this city of security	pointing with a Sifah, for بَلَدٌ
هَذَا الْجِدَارُ	this wall	جِدَارٌ is used as masculine in Arabic
هَذَا الْكَلْبُ	this dog	singular masculine
هَذِهِ السَّيَّارَةُ	this car	singular feminine
هَاتَانِ الْعُرْفَتَانِ	these two rooms	عُرْفَتَانِ is عُرْفَةٌ the dual of
هَؤُلَاءِ الْمُسْلِمُونَ	these Muslims	plural masculine, 'Aqil
هَذَانِ الدَّرْسَانِ	these two lessons	dual masculine
هَؤُلَاءِ الْبَنَاتُ	these girls	plural feminine, 'Aqil
هَذِهِ السَّرُرُ	these couches	a Ghayr 'Aqil plural

A Sifah with a Murakkab Isharee

Two of the examples in the table have a *Sifah* following the *Murakkab Isharee*: هَذَا and ذَلِكَ الْوَلَدُ الصَّالِحُ. In these two constructions have been combined — first a *Murakkab Isharee* and then a *Murakkab Tawsifi*. The *Sifah* too has come as *Mu'arraaf bil Lam*, because the *Mawsuf* is *Ma'rifah*.

12. The difference between a Jumla Ismiyyah and a Murakkab Isharee

This is the most important point of the lesson. The two constructions look alike, but there is one fundamental difference between them.

The fundamental difference: The two nouns from which a *Jumla Ismiyyah* is built must be **Ma'rifah + Nakirah** — this is a hundred percent condition. But in a *Murakkab Isharee*, since the *Asma' ul Isharah* are **Ma'rifah**, the *Mushar Ilayh* too is brought as **Ma'rifah** — that is, **Ma'rifah + Ma'rifah**.

Aspect	Murakkab Isharee		Jumla Ismiyyah	
Example	هَذَا الْكِتَابُ		هَذَا كِتَابٌ	
Element	هَذَا	الْكِتَابُ	هَذَا	كِتَابٌ
Wus'at	Ma'rifah	Ma'rifah	Ma'rifah	Nakirah
'Adad	Wahid	Wahid	Wahid	Wahid
I'raab	Marfoo'	Marfoo'	Marfoo'	Marfoo'
Jins	Mudhakkar	Mudhakkar	Mudhakkar	Mudhakkar
Translation	this book		this is a book	

An easy way to tell them apart: Look at the second noun. If it carries **alif lam**, this is a *Murakkab Isharee* and the sense is still incomplete. And if it carries **Tanween**, this is a *Jumla Ismiyyah* and the sense is complete.

How is a Murakkab Isharee made into a sentence?

Since a *Murakkab Isharee* is a *Murakkab Naqis*, to make it a complete sentence a *Nakirah Khabar* must be brought after it. In that case the whole *Murakkab Isharee* becomes the *Mubtada*.

- هَذَا الْكِتَابُ — this book (the sense is incomplete)
- هَذَا الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ — this book is new (the sense is complete)

In the second example the whole of هَذَا الْكِتَابُ is the *Mubtada* and جَدِيدٌ is the *Khabar*.

Summary

1. Any word used alone, apart from a sentence, is called Mufrad, and when a mufrad joins another mufrad a Murakkab is formed.
2. The Murakkab is of two kinds: the Murakkab Tamm, from which the sense is complete, and the Murakkab Naqis, from which it is not.
3. A Murakkab Naqis in which the Asma' ul Isharah are used is called a Murakkab Isharee.
4. A Murakkab Isharee does not by itself form a sentence; it forms one element of a sentence.
5. It has two parts: the Ism ul Isharah and the Mushar Ilayh. That which is pointed at is the Mushar Ilayh.
6. In Arabic the Ism ul Isharah comes first and the Mushar Ilayh after it, and the Ism ul Isharah is chosen to match the Mushar Ilayh.
7. The Asma' ul Isharah are of two broad kinds: those for what is near and those for what is far.
8. The singular and plural Asma' ul Isharah are Mabni, and only the dual ones are Mu'rab.
9. In a Murakkab Isharee agreement is required in all three of gender, number and I'raab.
10. In respect of wus'at the Asma' ul Isharah are Ma'rifah, so the Mushar Ilayh is always Mu'arraf bil Lam.
11. Since the singular and plural Asma' ul Isharah are Mabni, their I'raab is determined by looking at the I'raab of the Mushar Ilayh.
12. If the Mushar Ilayh is Marfoo' the Ism ul Isharah is mahallan Marfoo'; if Mansoob then mahallan Mansoob; and if Majroor then mahallan Majroor.
13. In the dual the I'raab is plainly visible: هَذَانِ الْوَلَدَانِ in the state of raf' and هَذَيْنِ الْوَلَدَيْنِ in nasb and jarr.
14. In translating, the Ism ul Isharah is rendered first and the Mushar Ilayh after it.
15. When هَذِهِ is joined to a word carrying al-, its kasrah becomes light: هَذِهِ الْبَيْتُ.
16. If the Mushar Ilayh is a Jam' Mukassar of the Ghayr 'Aqil, the singular feminine Ism ul Isharah is used — تِلْكَ or هَذِهِ.
17. This is why الْقَلَمُ, though masculine, takes هَذِهِ الْقَلَامُ for its plural.
18. A Sifah may follow a Murakkab Isharee, as in ذَلِكَ الْوَلَدُ الصَّالِحُ, where a Murakkab Isharee and a Murakkab Tawsifi have been combined.
19. A Jumla Ismiyyah joins a Ma'rifah with a Nakirah, whereas a Murakkab Isharee joins a Ma'rifah with a Ma'rifah.
20. The easy test is this: if the second noun carries alif lam it is a Murakkab Isharee, and if it carries Tanween it is a Jumla Ismiyyah.
21. Bringing a Nakirah Khabar after a Murakkab Isharee makes the whole construction the Muftada and completes the sentence, as in هَذَا الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ.

Exercise

1. Define Mufrad and Murakkab, and explain both kinds of Murakkab with examples.

2. Define the Murakkab Isharee and give three examples.
3. Name both parts of a Murakkab Isharee and state their order.
4. Set out all the near and far Asma' ul Isharah in the form of a table.
5. Which of the Asma' ul Isharah are Mabni and which are Mu'rab?
6. In which three aspects is agreement required in a Murakkab Isharee?
7. Why is the Mushar Ilayh always Mu'arraf bil Lam?
8. How is the I'raab of a Murakkab Isharee determined? Write all three states.
9. Why is the I'raab more plainly visible in the dual? Give an example of each state.
10. Write the rule of translation and render هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ by it.
11. What change occurs when هَذِهِ is joined to a word with al-?
12. Form the singular, dual and plural constructions for all four kinds using the words Talib and Salih.
13. Write the particular rule for a Ghayr 'Aqil plural and give three examples.
14. الْأَقْلَامُ is the plural of a masculine noun, so why does هَذِهِ come for it?
15. Which two constructions have been combined in ذَلِكَ الْوَلَدُ الصَّالِحُ?
16. Set out the difference between a Jumla Ismiyyah and a Murakkab Isharee in the form of a table.
17. How would هَذَا الْكِتَابُ be made into a complete sentence? Separate the Muftada and the Khabar.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ